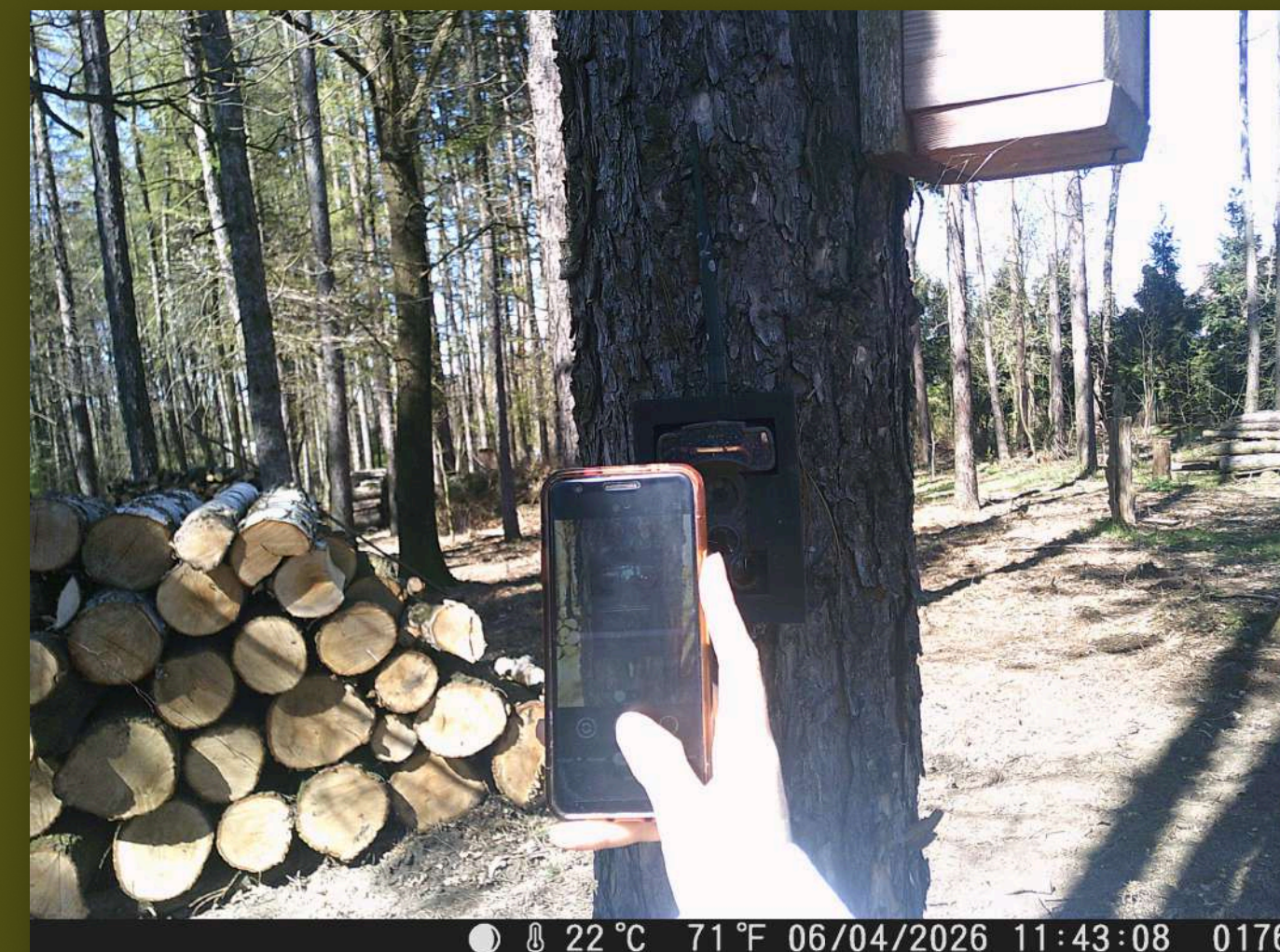


Permacomputing: Small Entrances for a Wide Collective



What is permacomputing?

- Comes from permaculture (Bill Mollison & David Holmgren, Tasmania, late 70s)



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 - b. Care of People
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- Philosophy: work with nature, not against → thoughtful observation, not rash action



Political context of permaculture's emergence

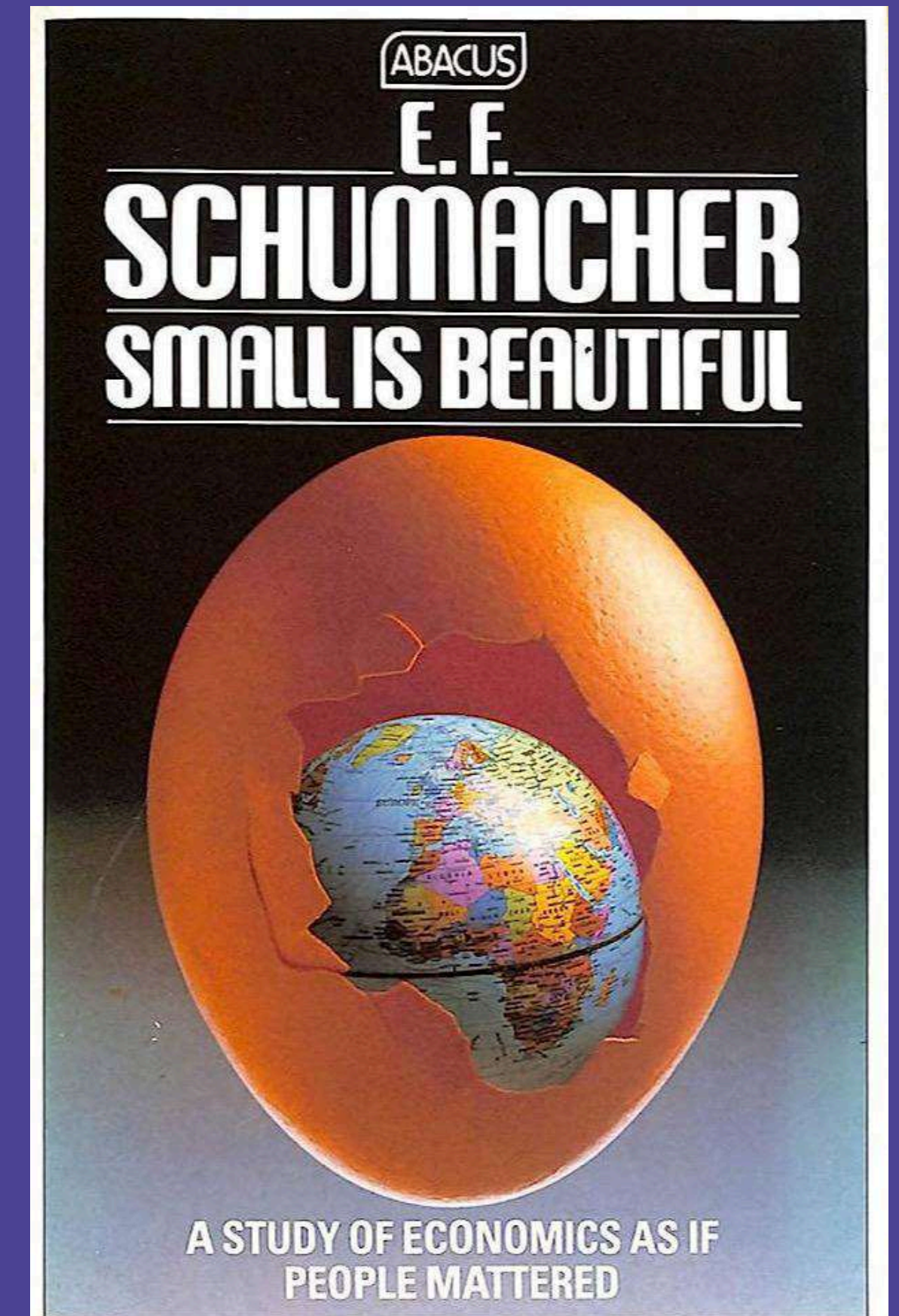
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Political context of permaculture's emergence

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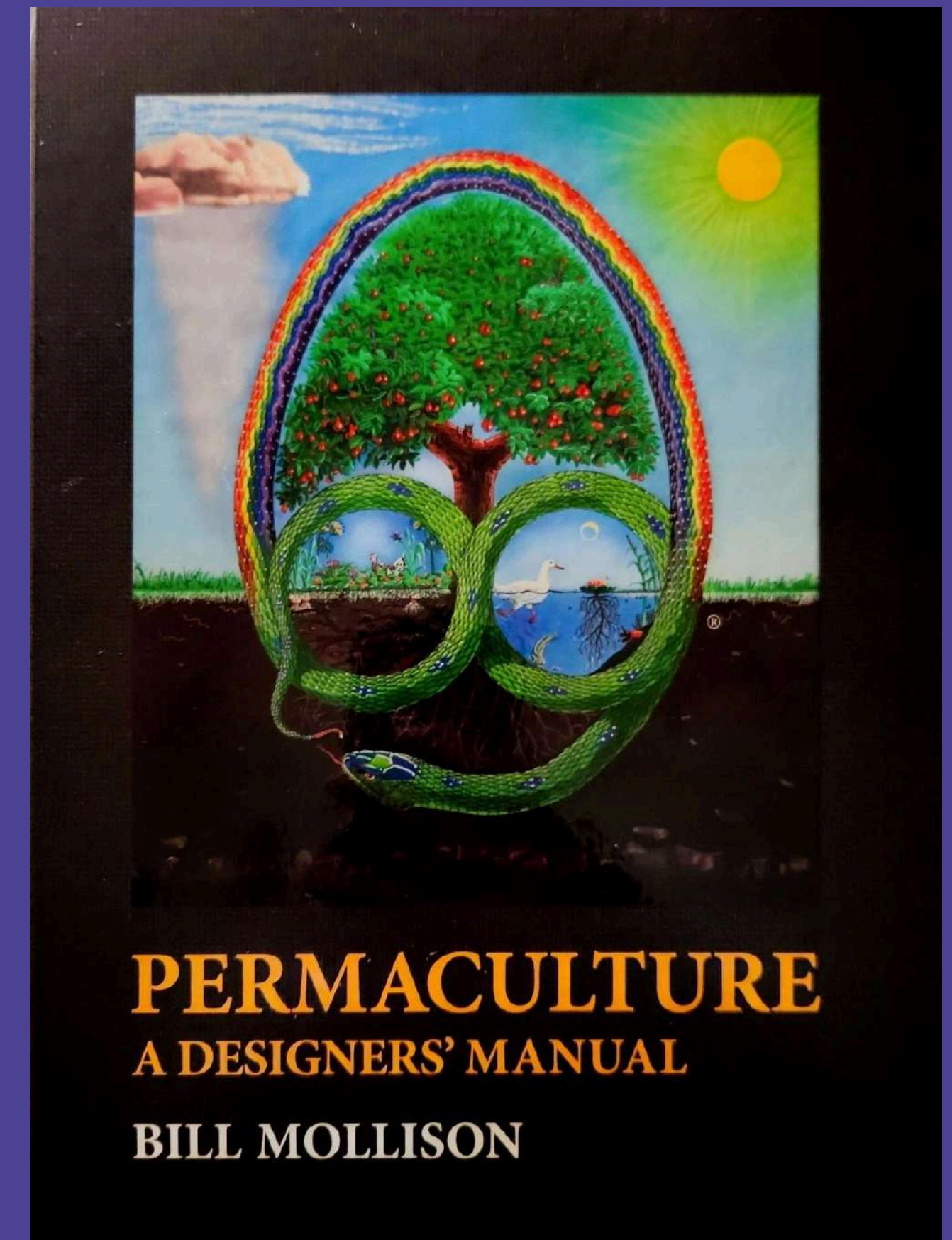
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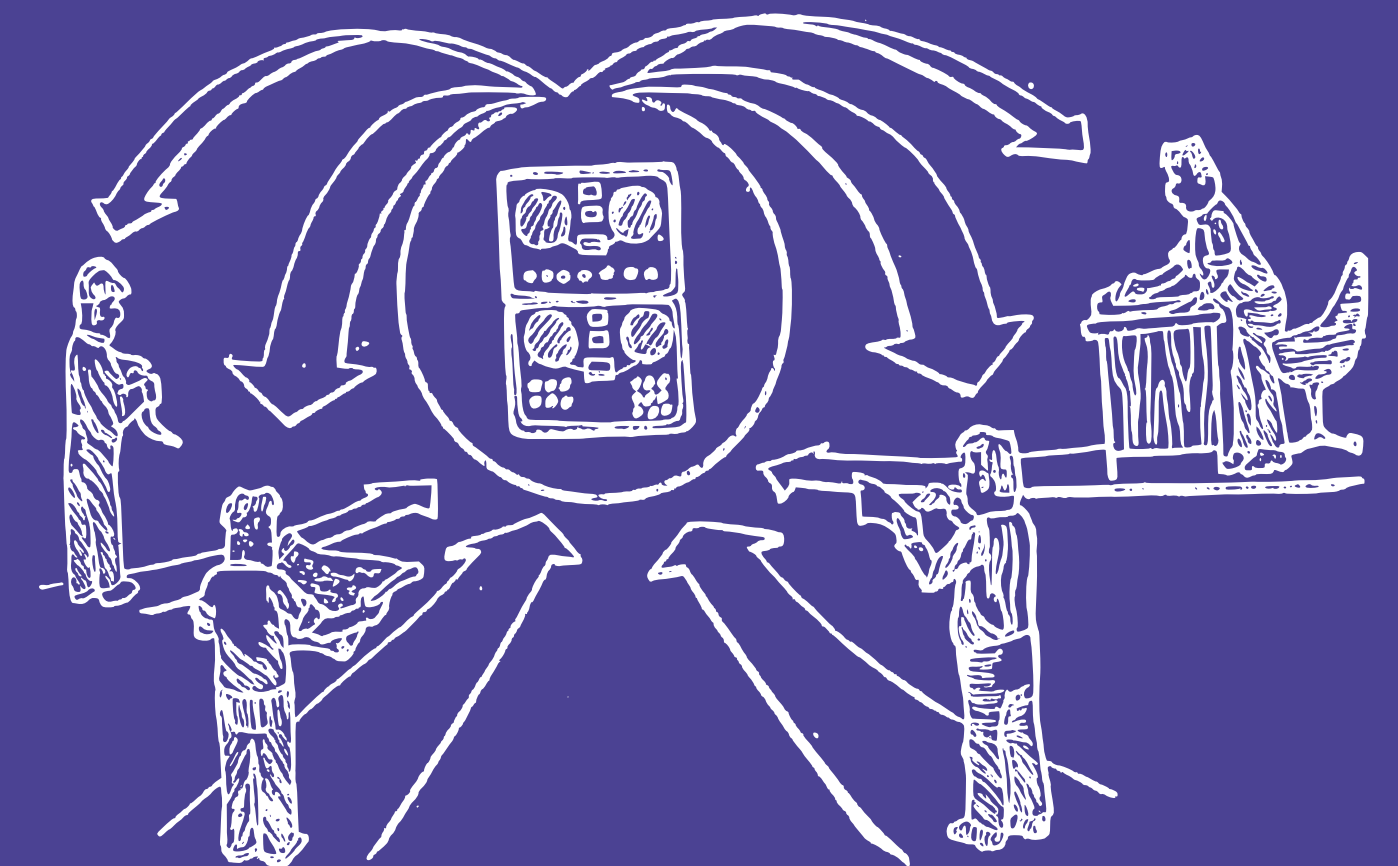
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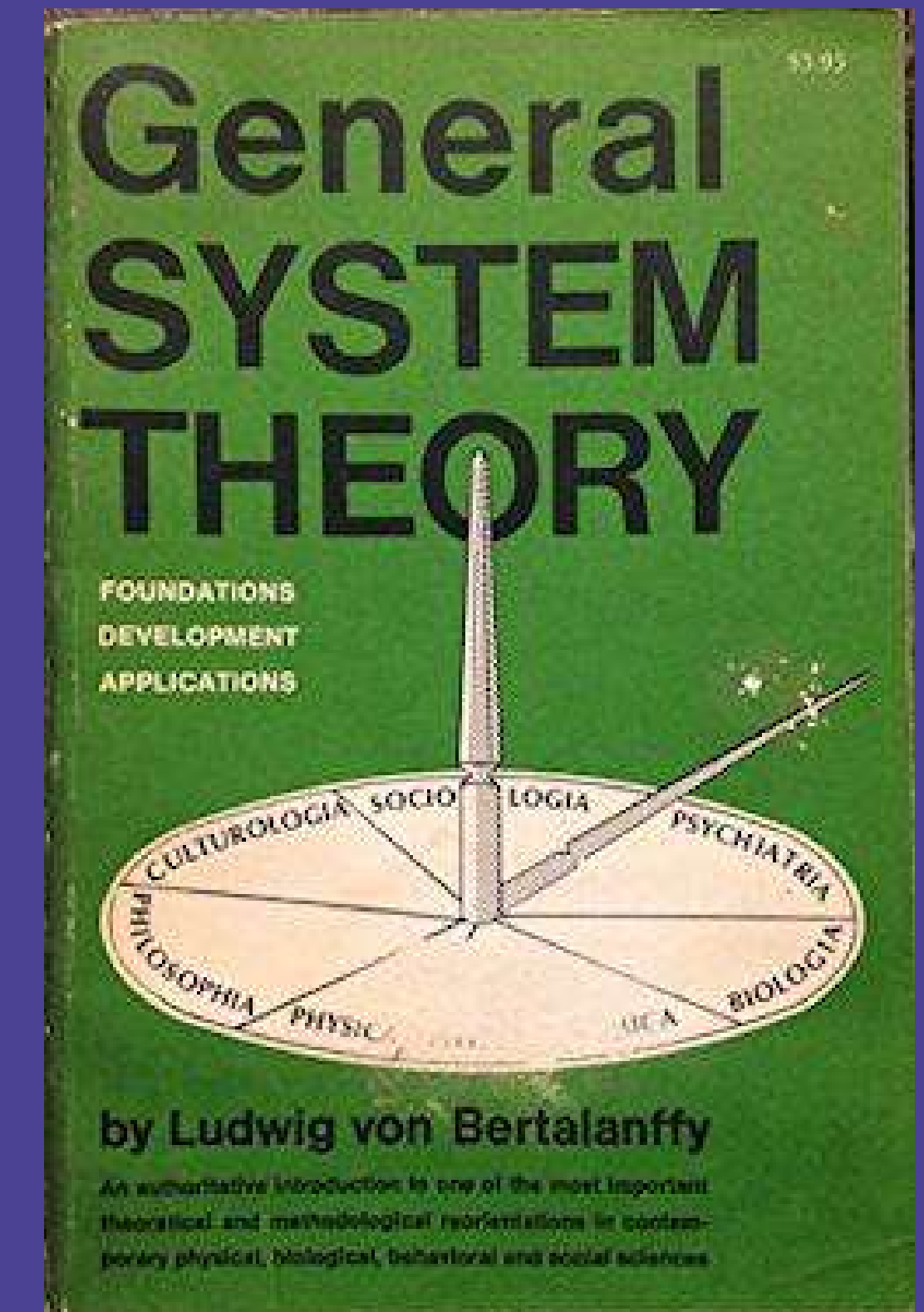
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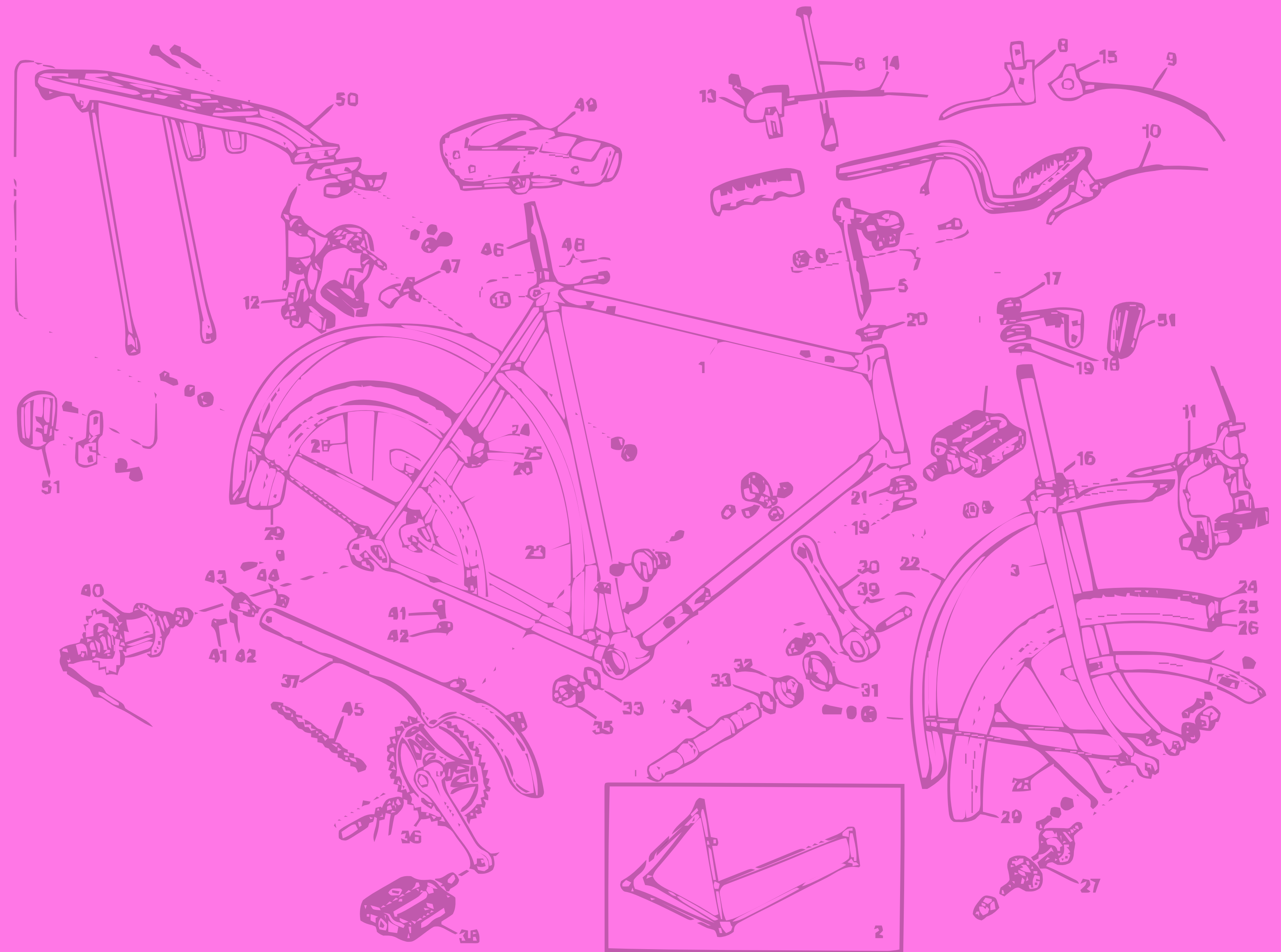
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- Systems theory (Bertalanffy: "a system is more than the sum of its parts")



Permacomputing = permaculture applied to computing

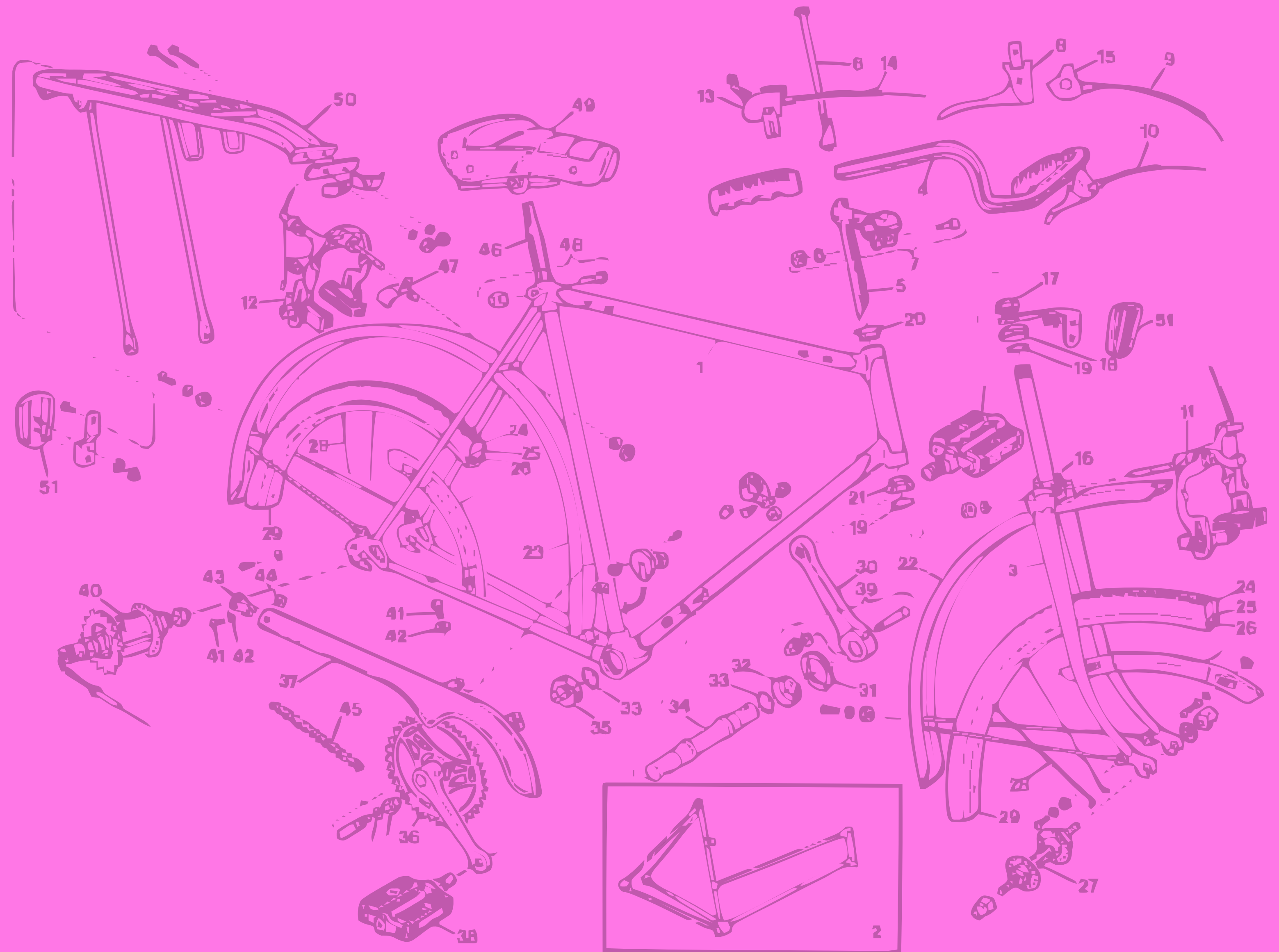
Main manifestations



Permacomputing = permaculture applied to computing

Main manifestations

1. Repair

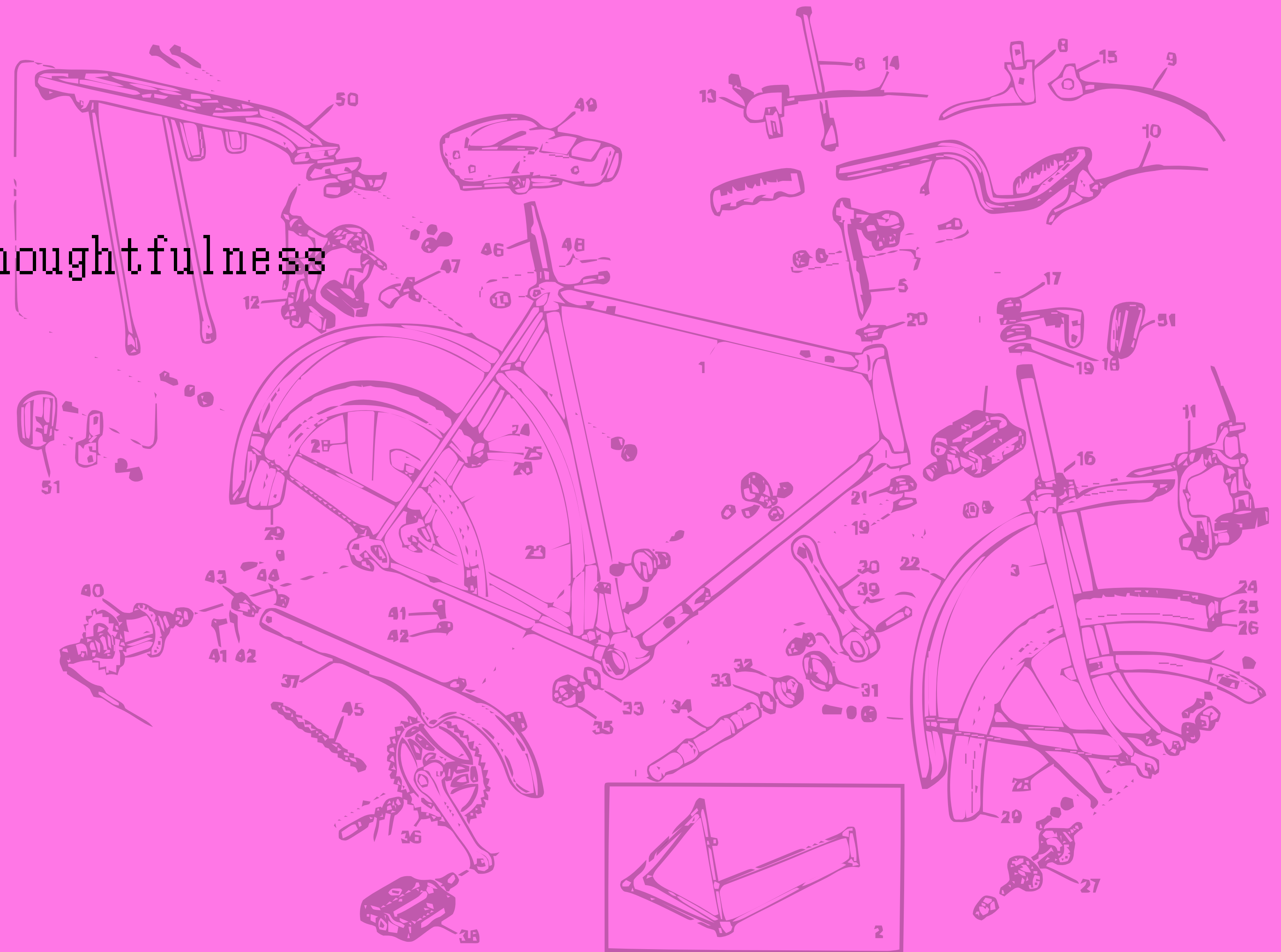


Permacomputing = permaculture applied to computing

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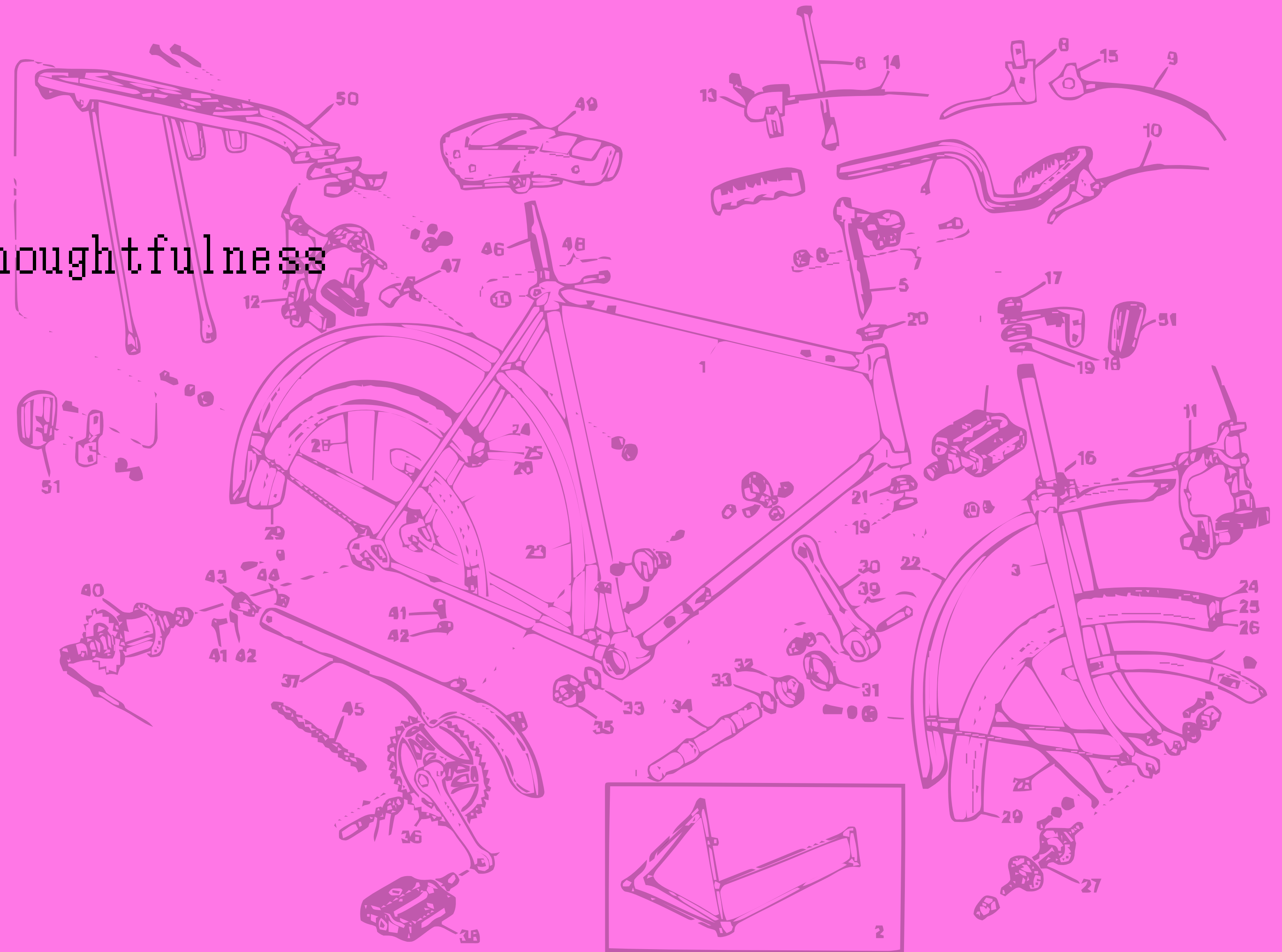
2. Slow computing & thoughtfulness



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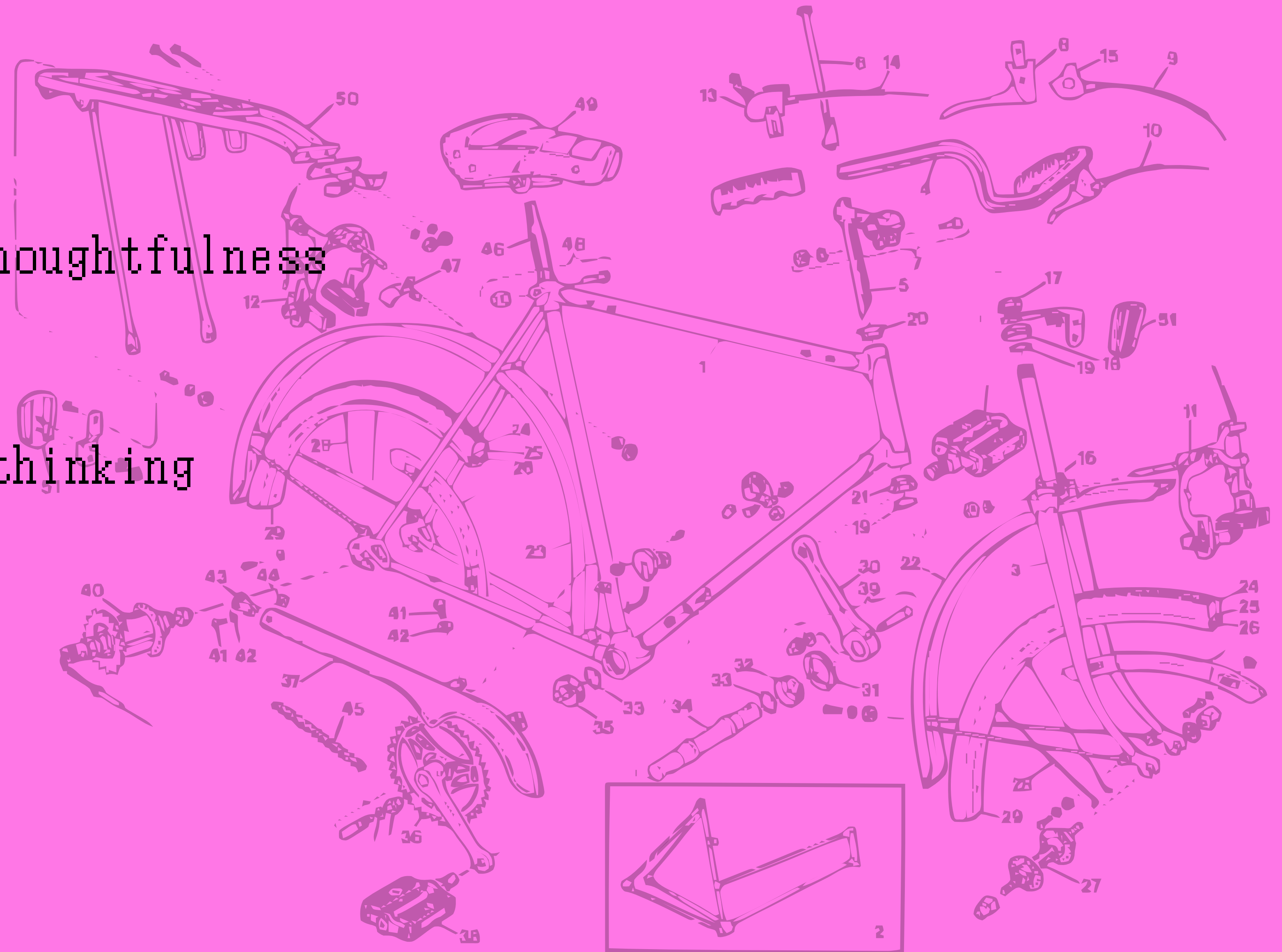
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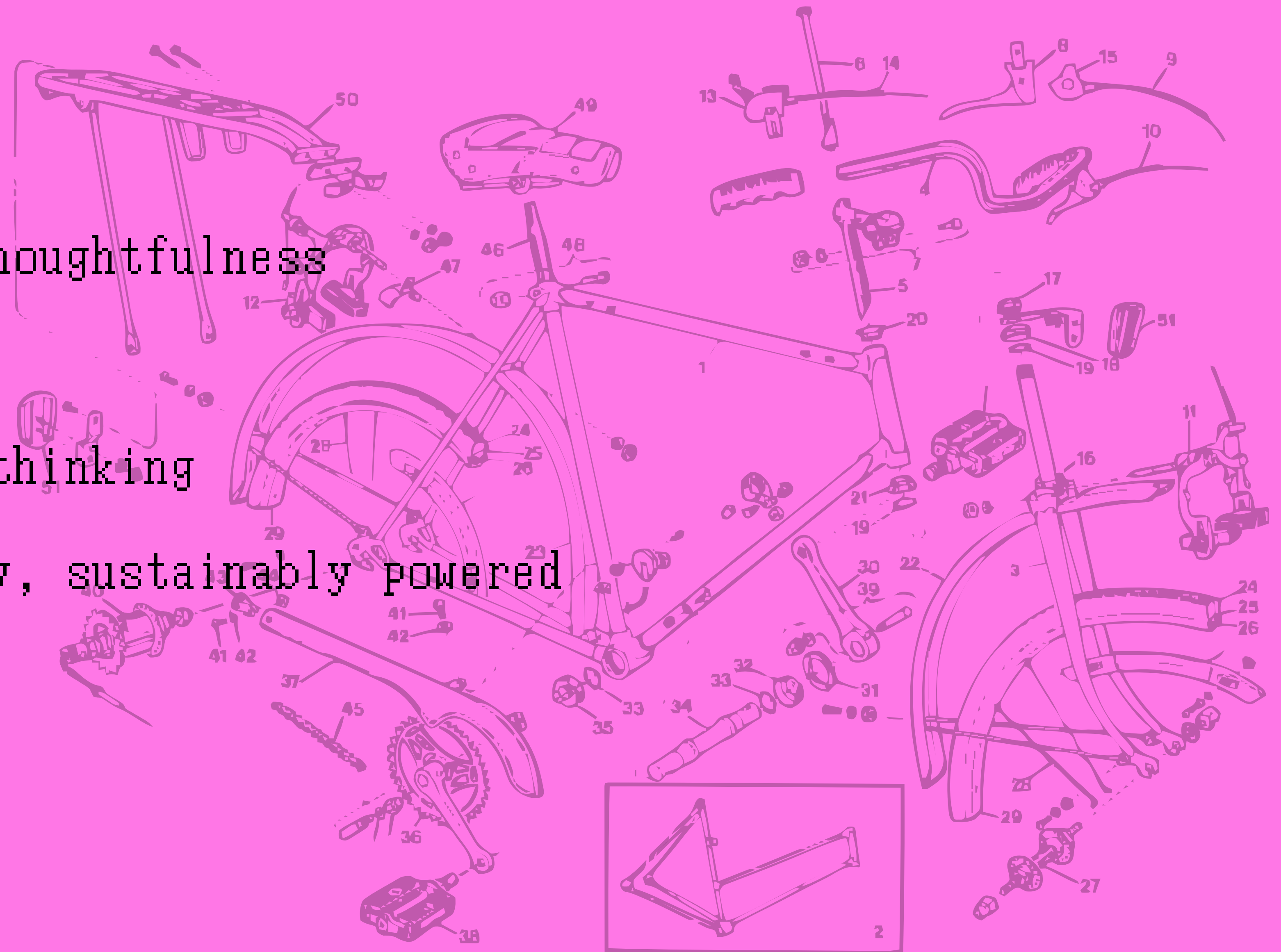
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4. Transdisciplinary thinking



Permacomputing = permaculture applied to computing

Main manifestations

1. Repair
2. Slow computing & thoughtfulness
3. Digital diversity
4. Transdisciplinary thinking
5. Minimal, low energy, sustainably powered



What is "harmful tech"?

This Panopticon



could have
been an e-mail.

What is "harmful tech"?

- Capitalist tech
- Scaling

This Panopticon



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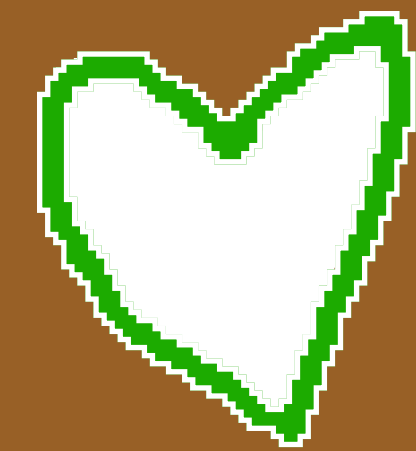
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 - Precarious
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 - Unreadable, inaccessible, technical debt
 - Baked-in biases you can't inspect

This Panopticon



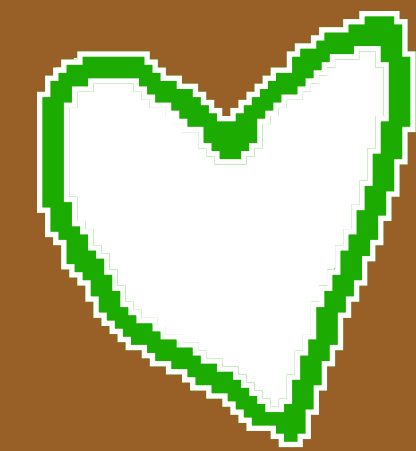
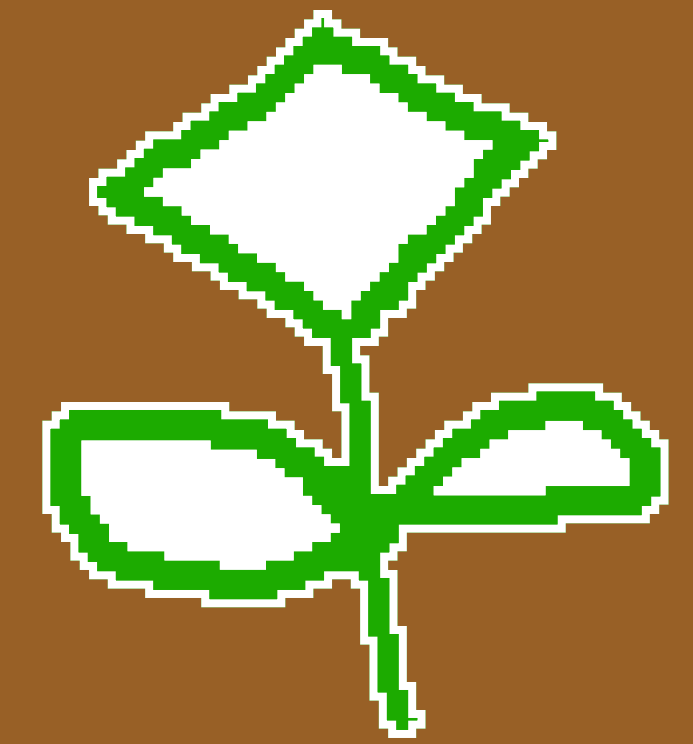
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Some key permacomputing principles



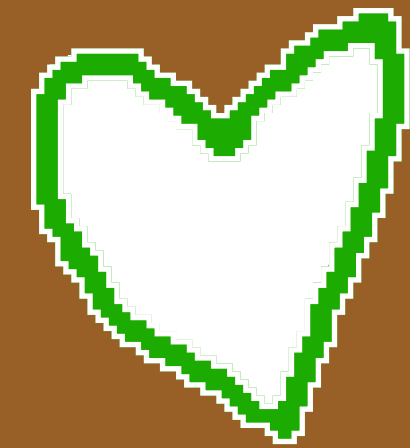
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1. "Not Doing" & "Observe First"



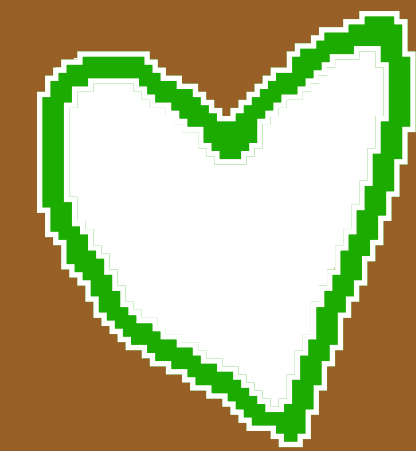
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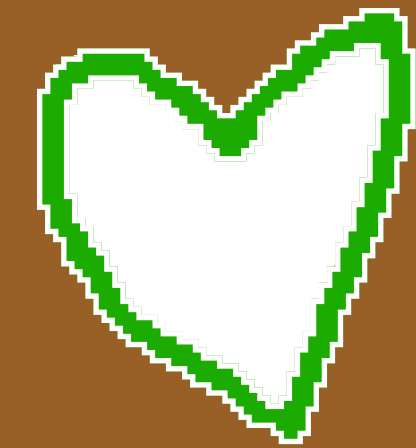
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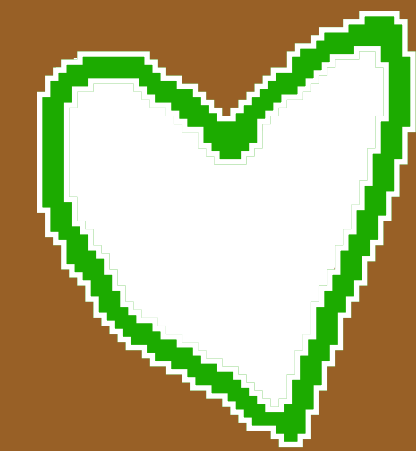
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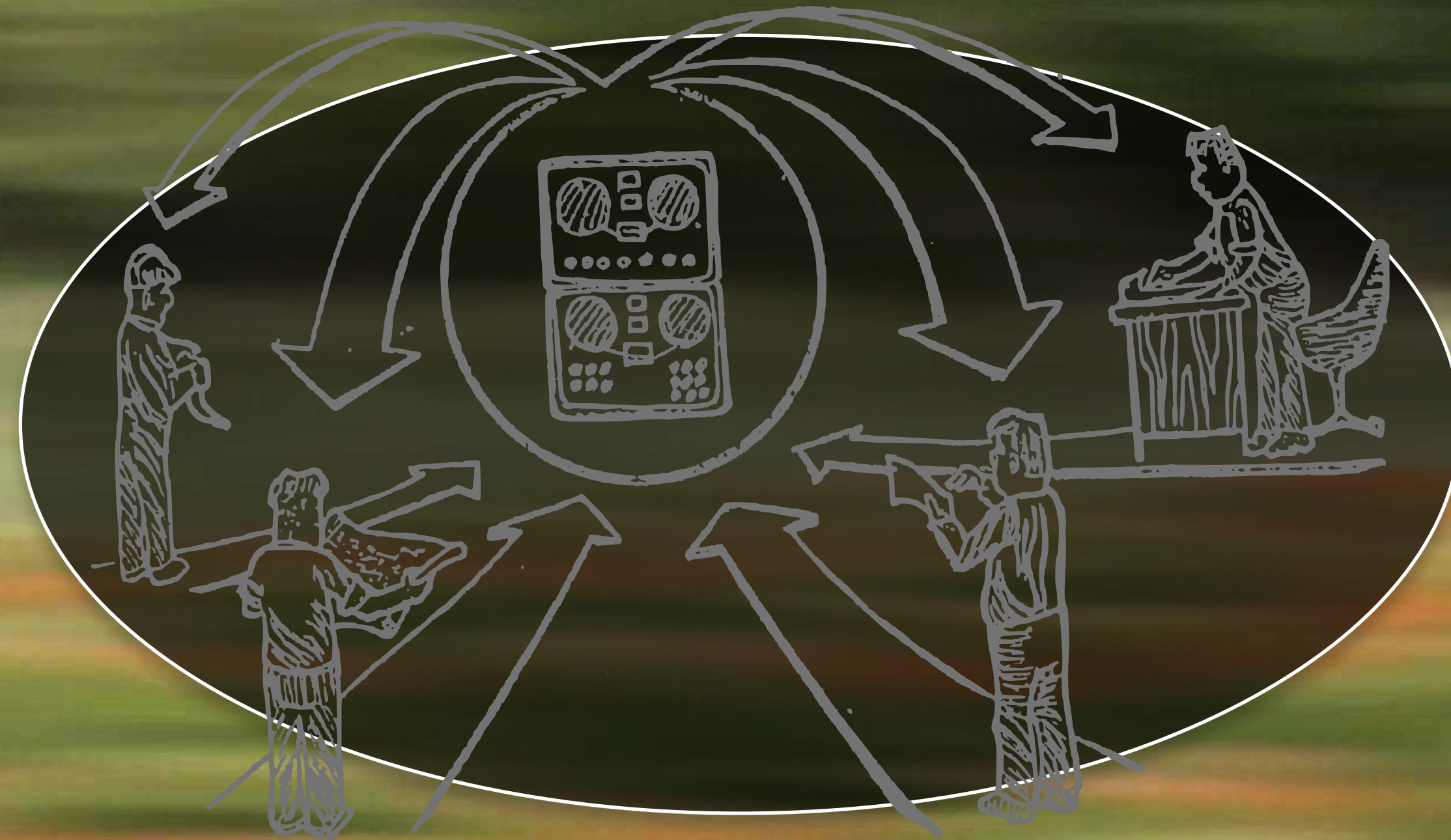
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5. "Keep It Flexible" & "Build on Solid Ground"



"Repair, after
all, is a
social
activity."

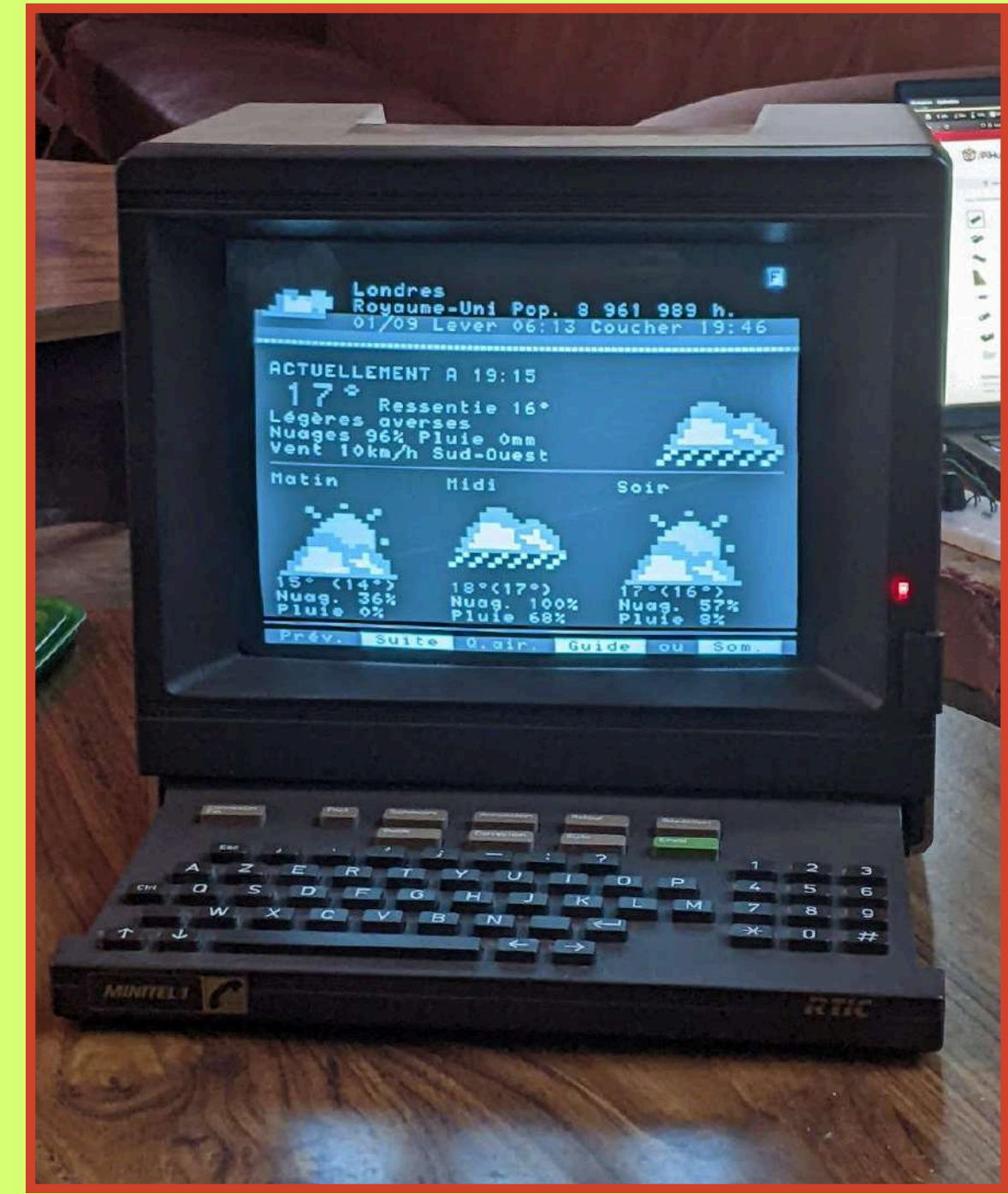
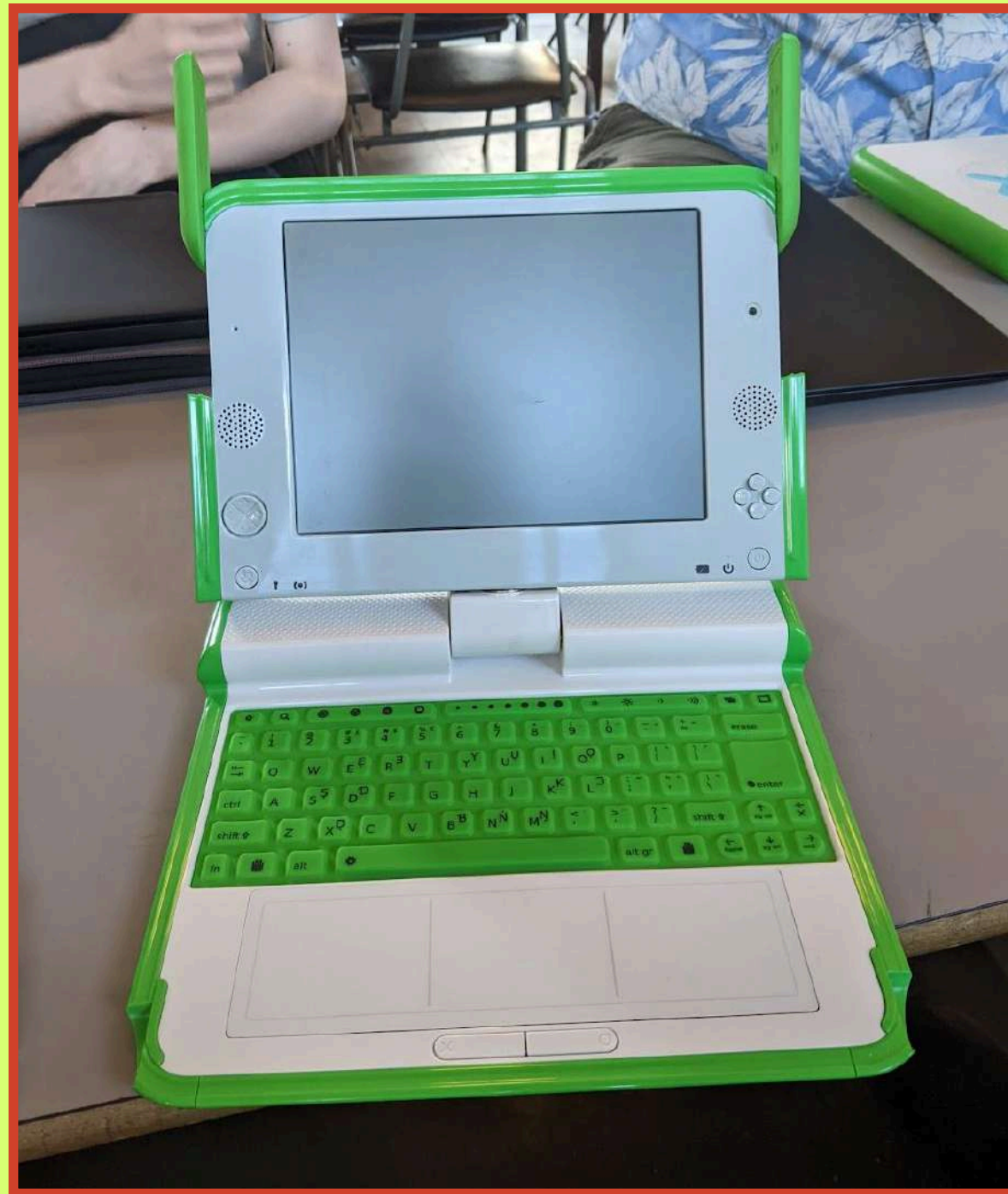
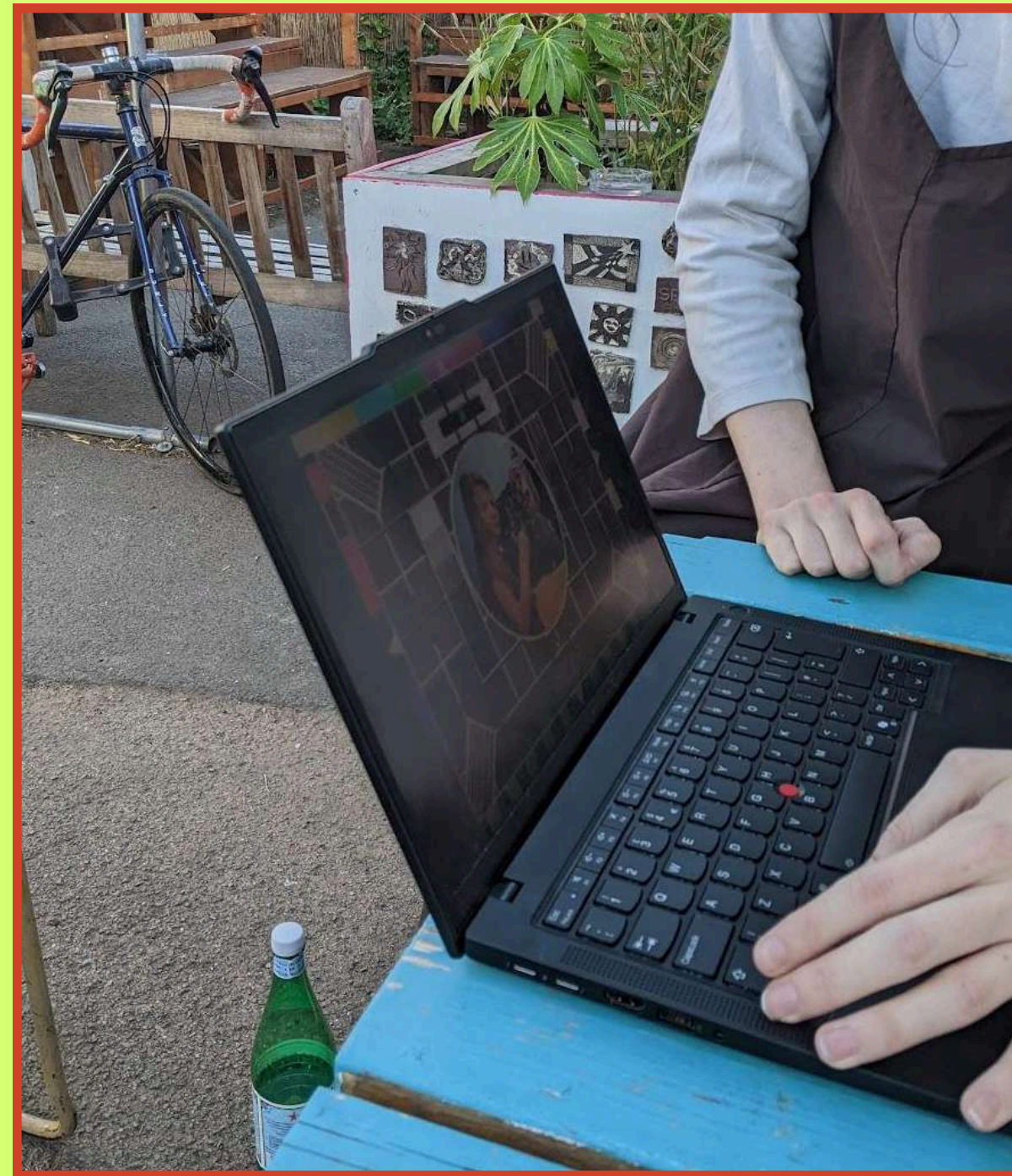
– Shannon
Mattern,
Maintenance
and Care



Permacomputing
Club

London

April 7 2025 → every Monday evening



Multi-cropping
CMS day

Printer hacker
project



HTML day

Workshops:

Internet privacy

Linux

Virtual machines

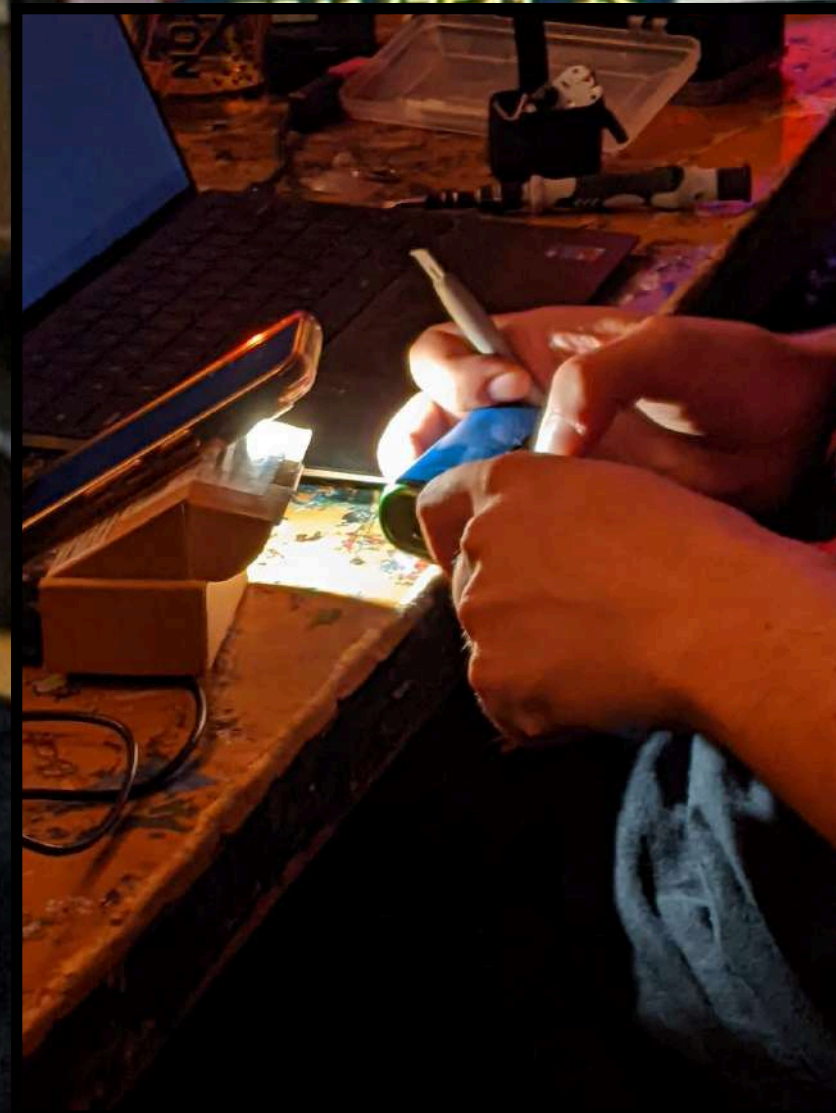
Bash and the terminal

Remote hosting

Poetry in code

Sourcehut

Literate programming



Tech Crits



"In speaking their word that people, by naming the world,
transform it."

- Paolo Friere, Pedagogy of the Oppressed

Feminist perspectives (Marloes de Valk) *



* The Image at the End of the World:
Communities of practice redefining technology on a damaged Earth

Feminist perspectives (Marloes
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Conviviality (Ivan Illich,
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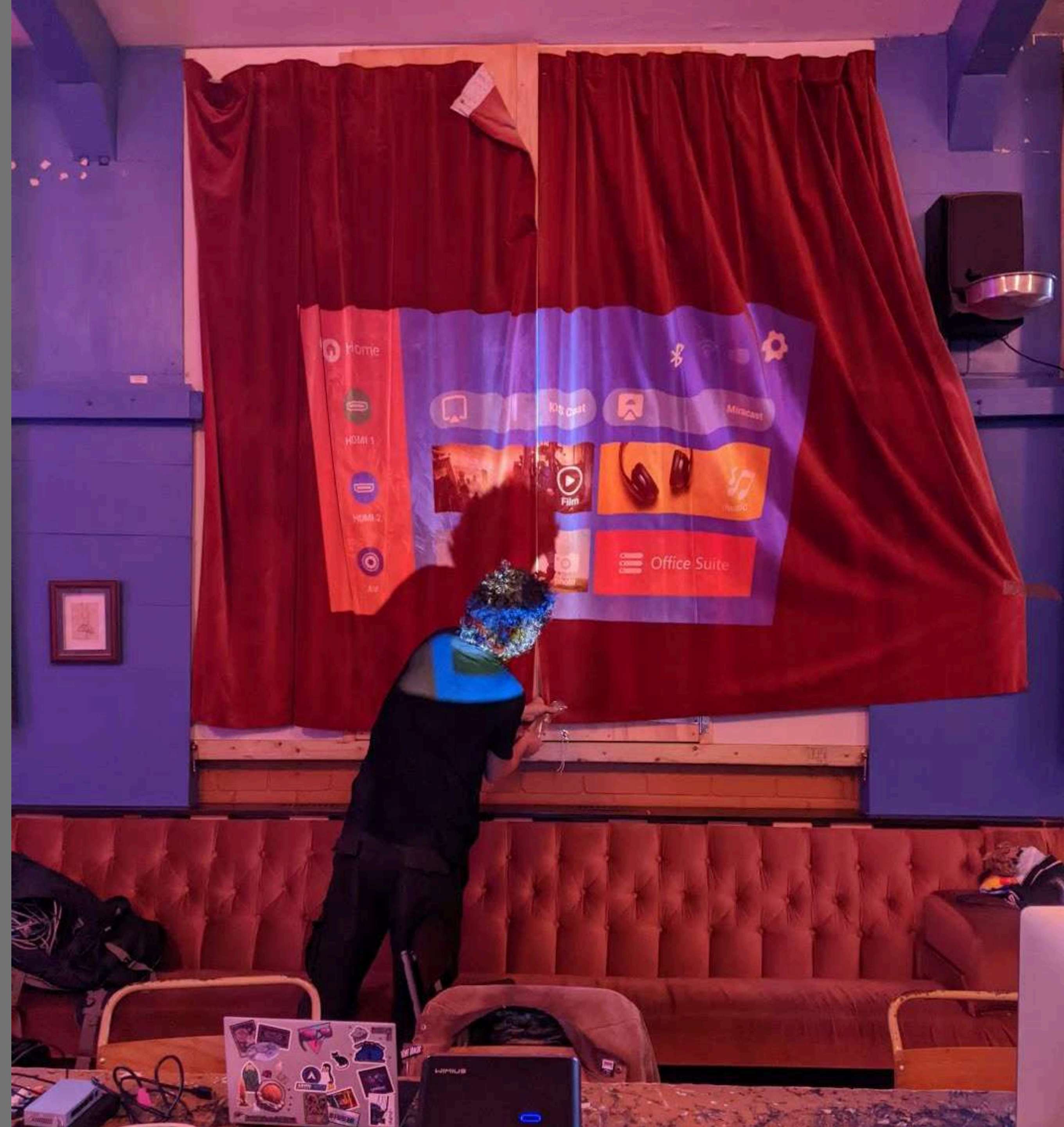


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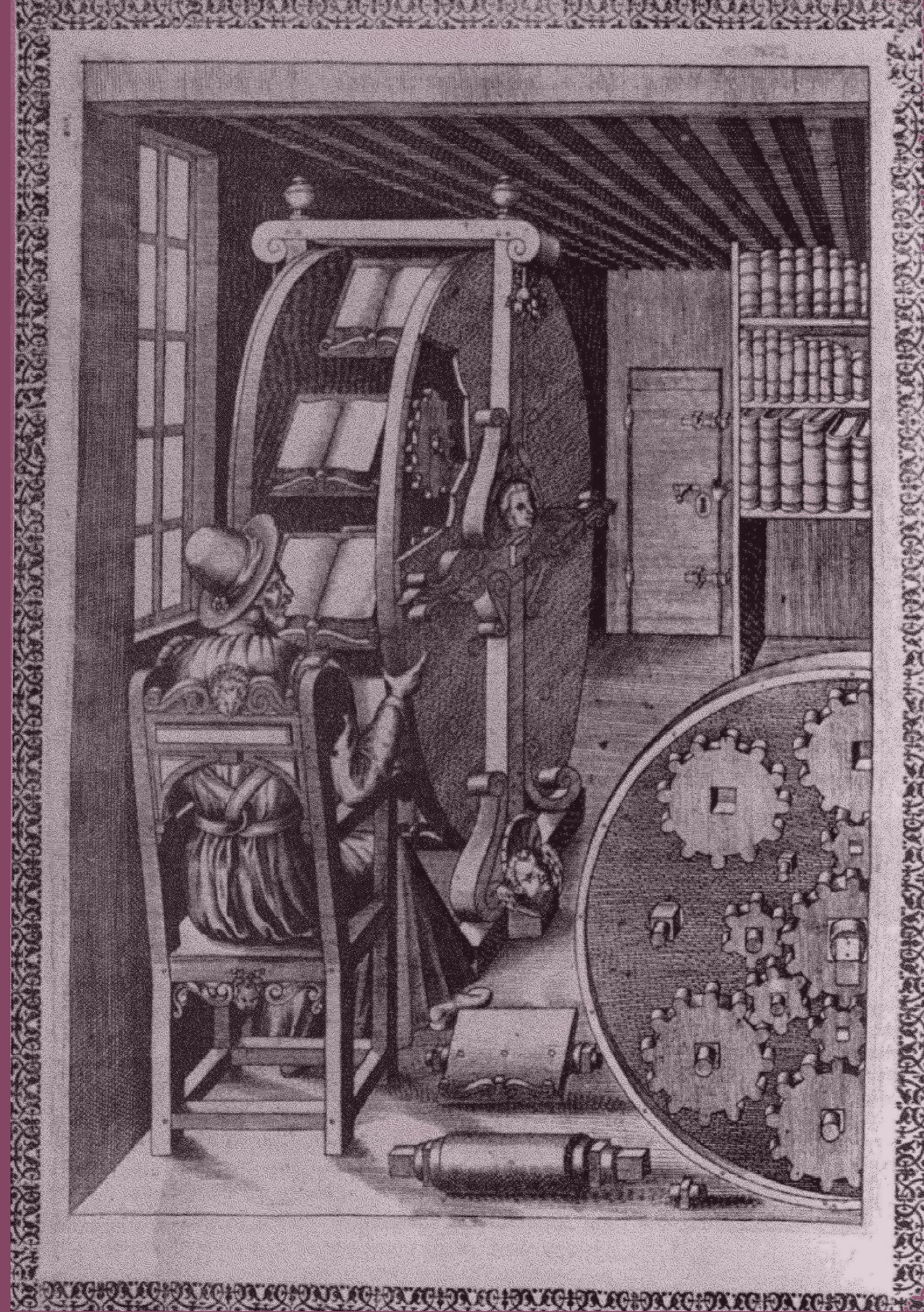
De-computing (Dan McQuillan)

- Degrowth, de-automatisation, care, conviviality

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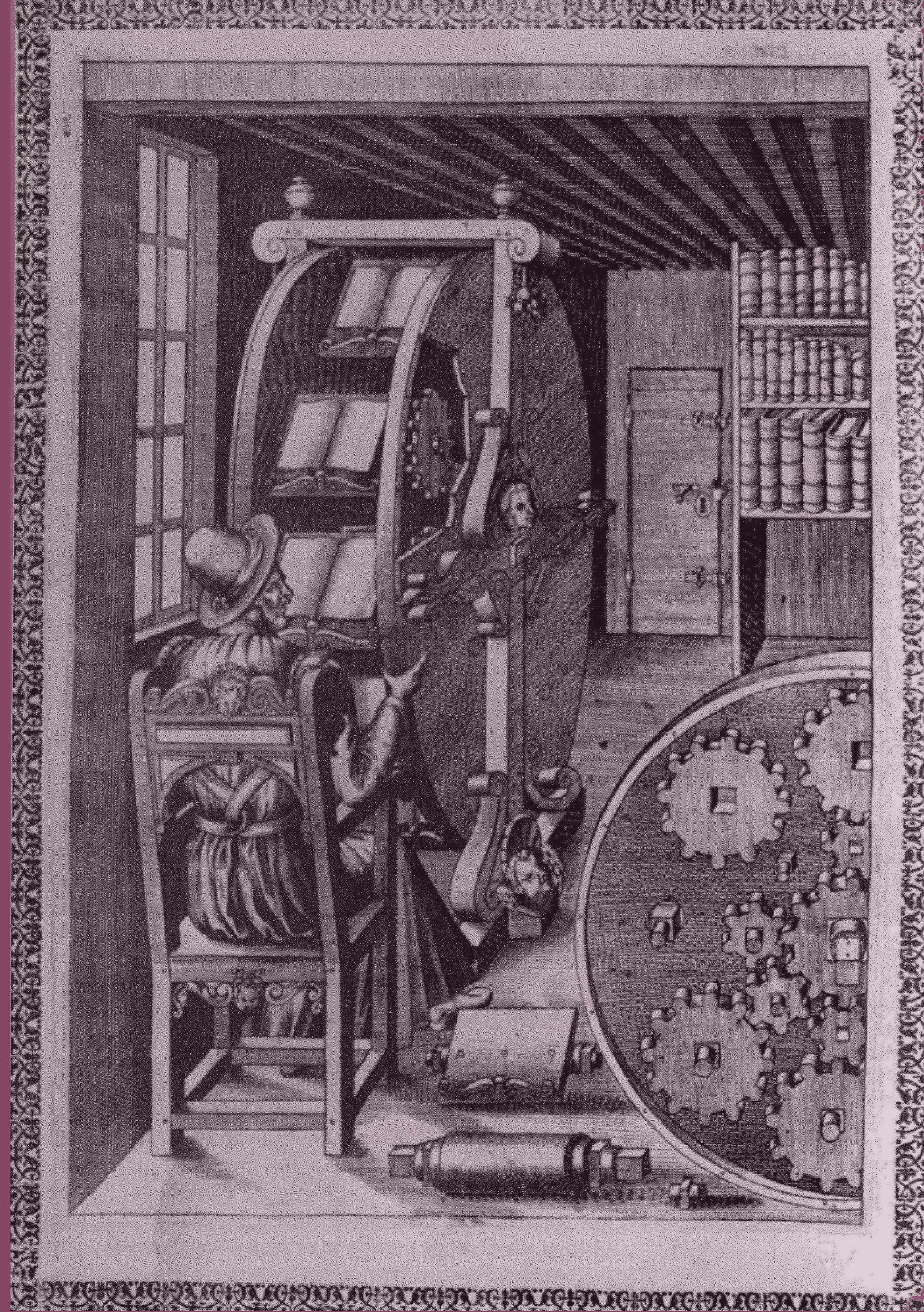


Historical parallels



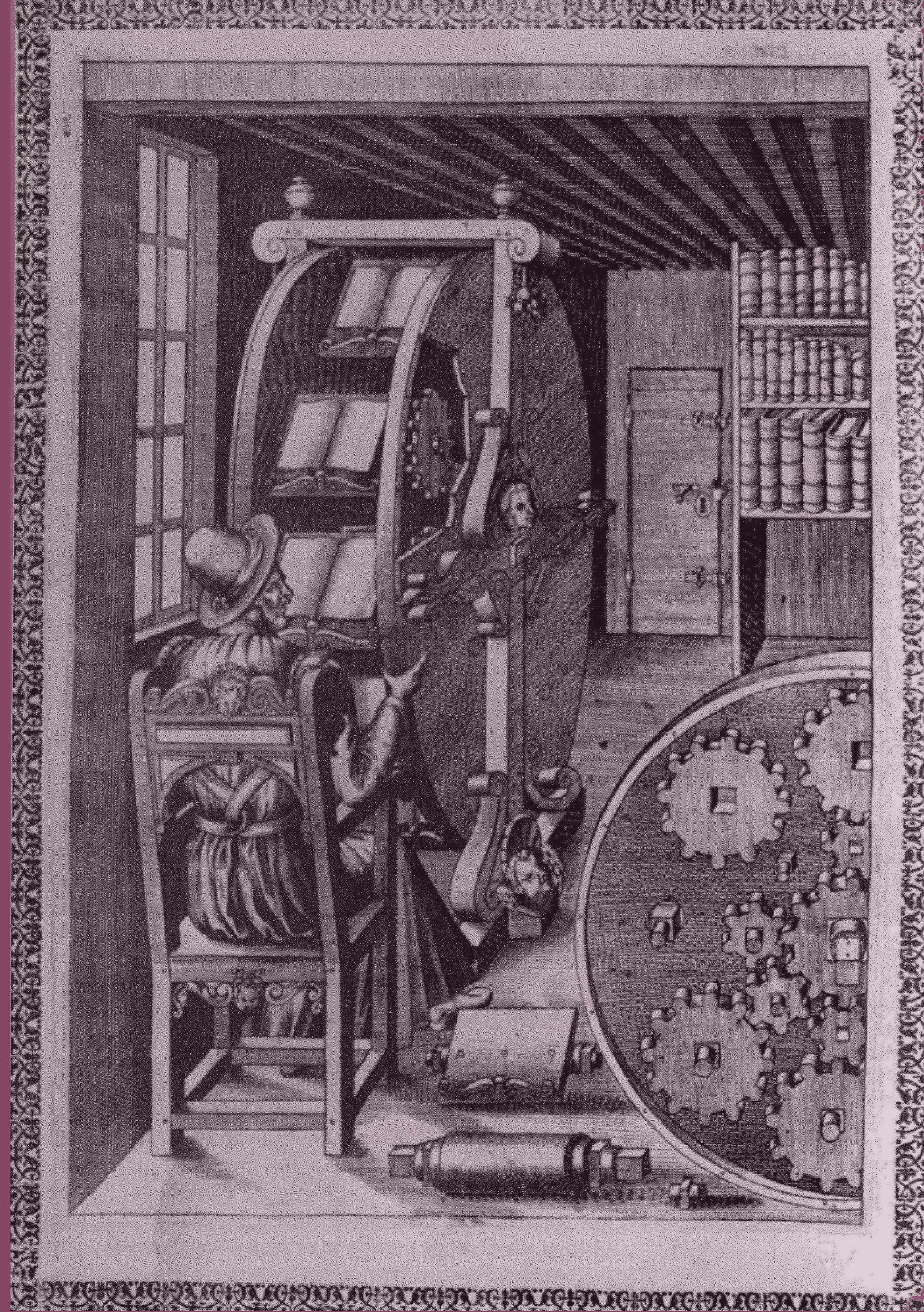
Historical parallels

- Luddites (early 19th c.) destroyed machinery threatening livelihoods



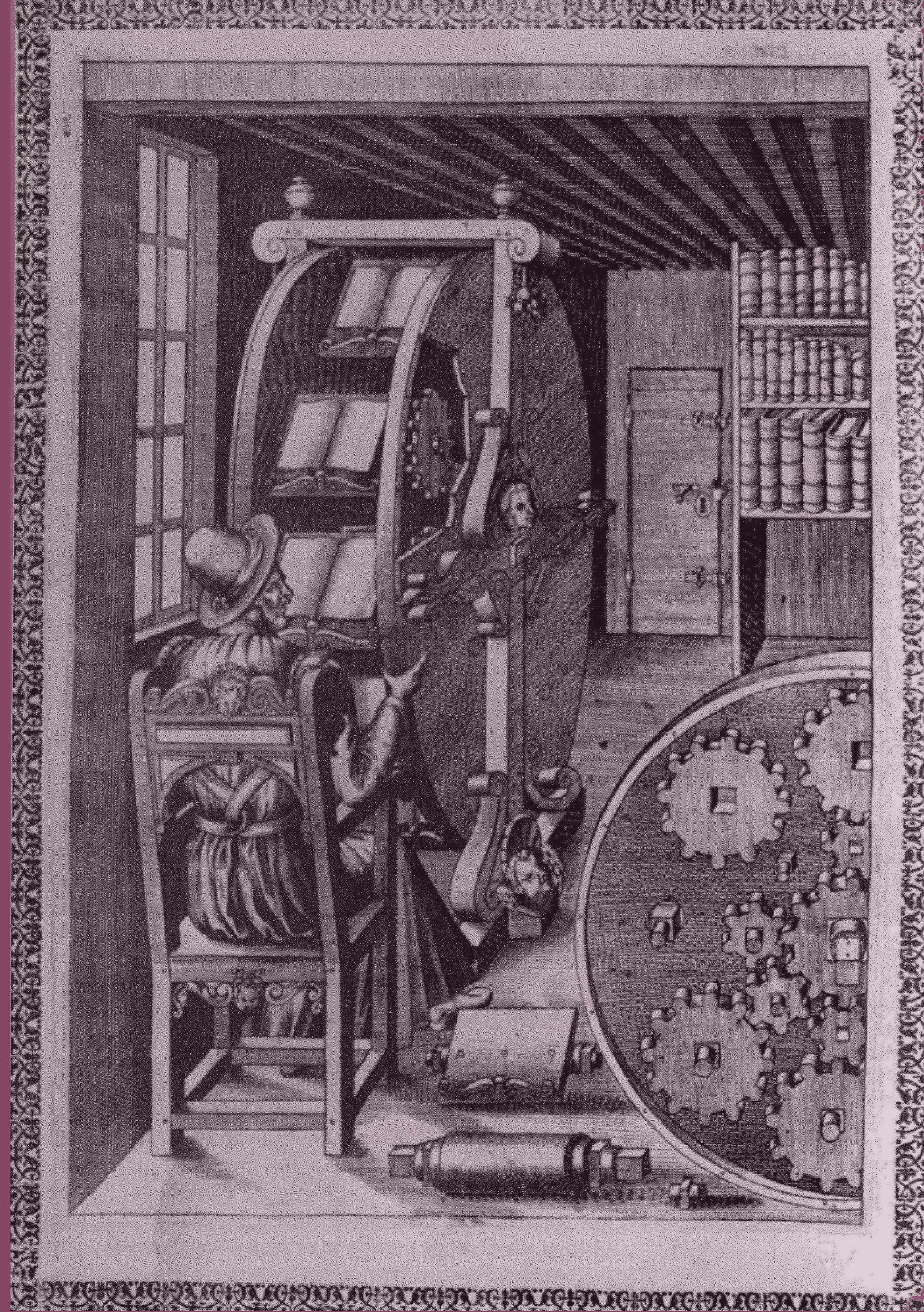
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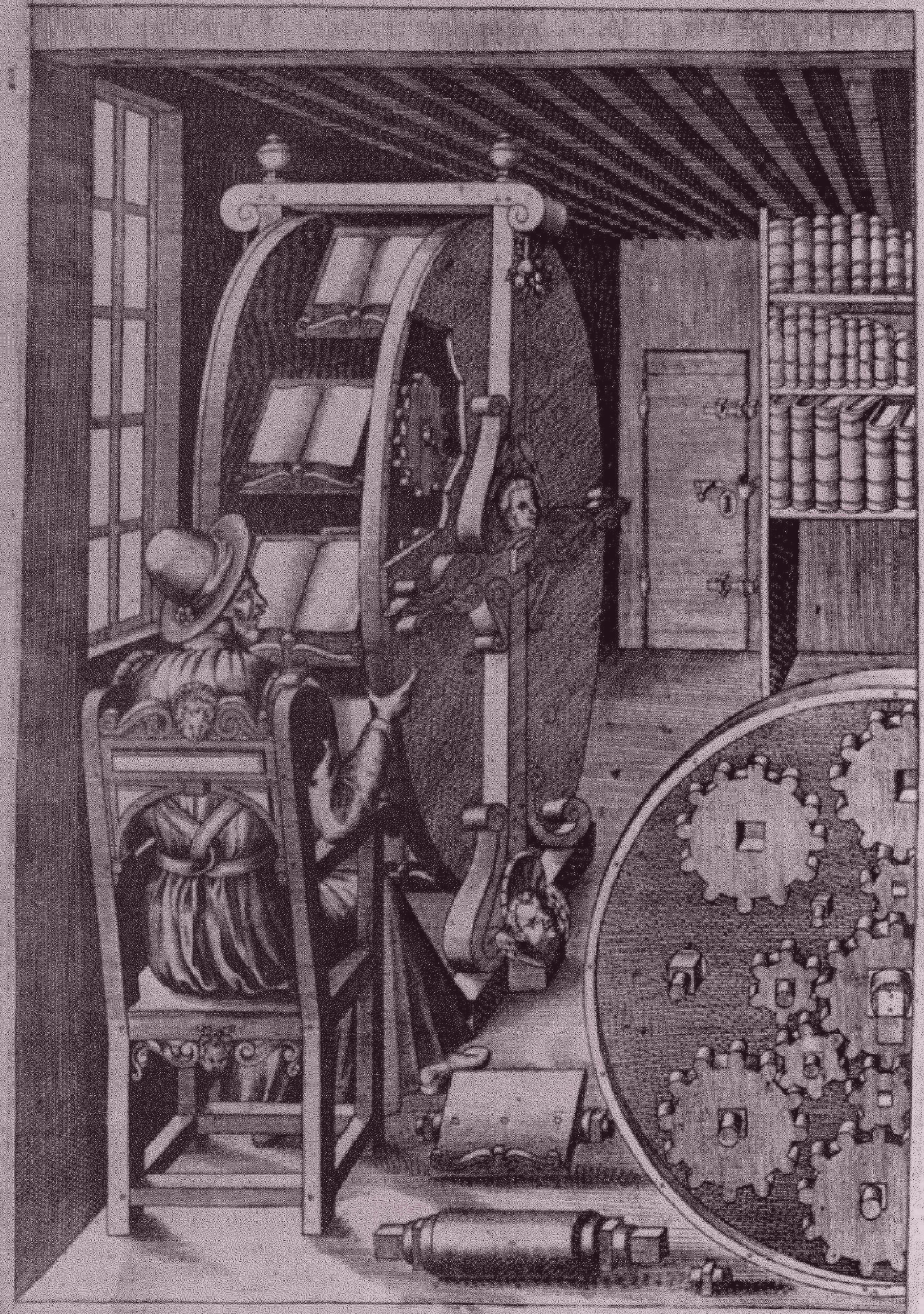
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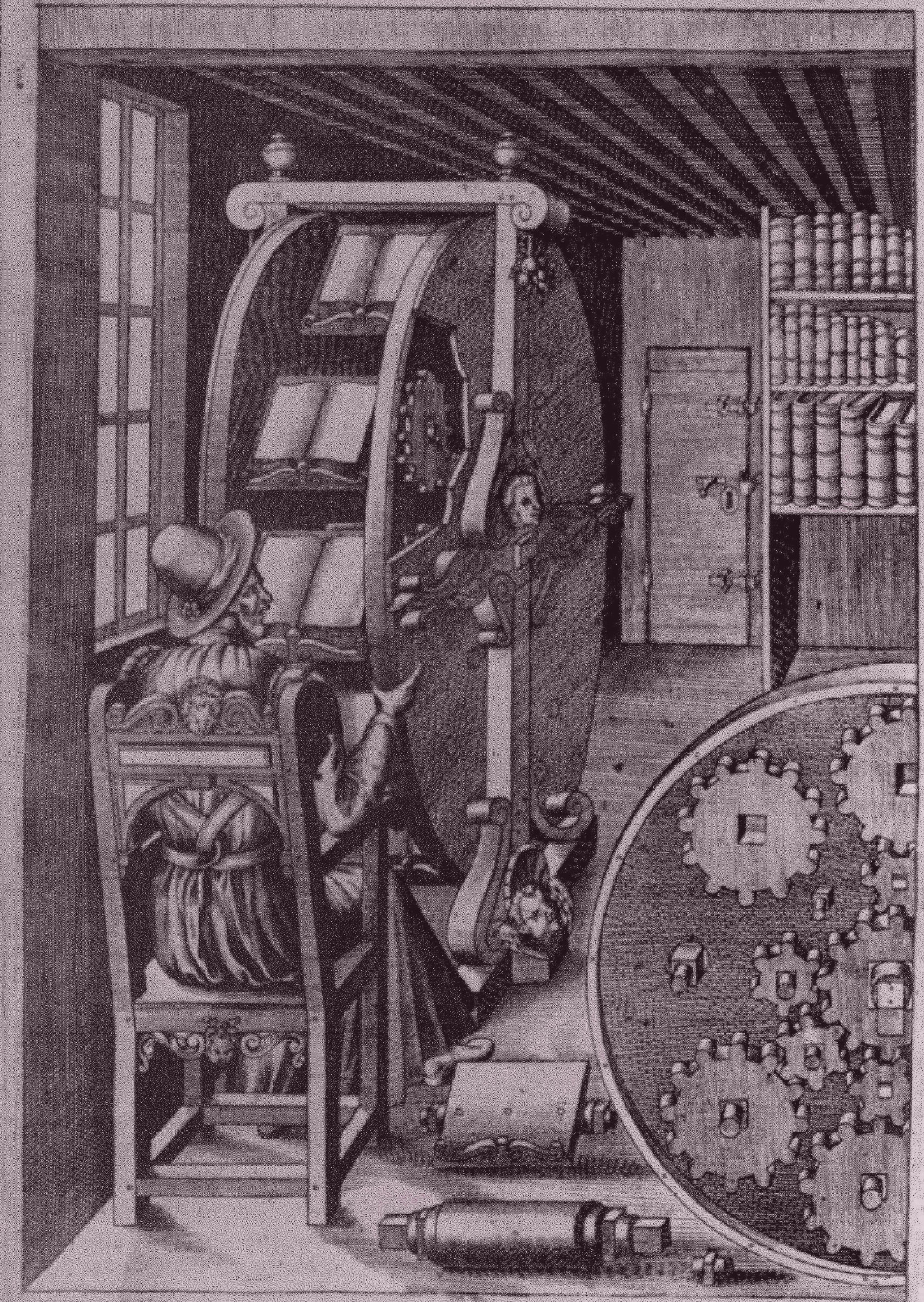
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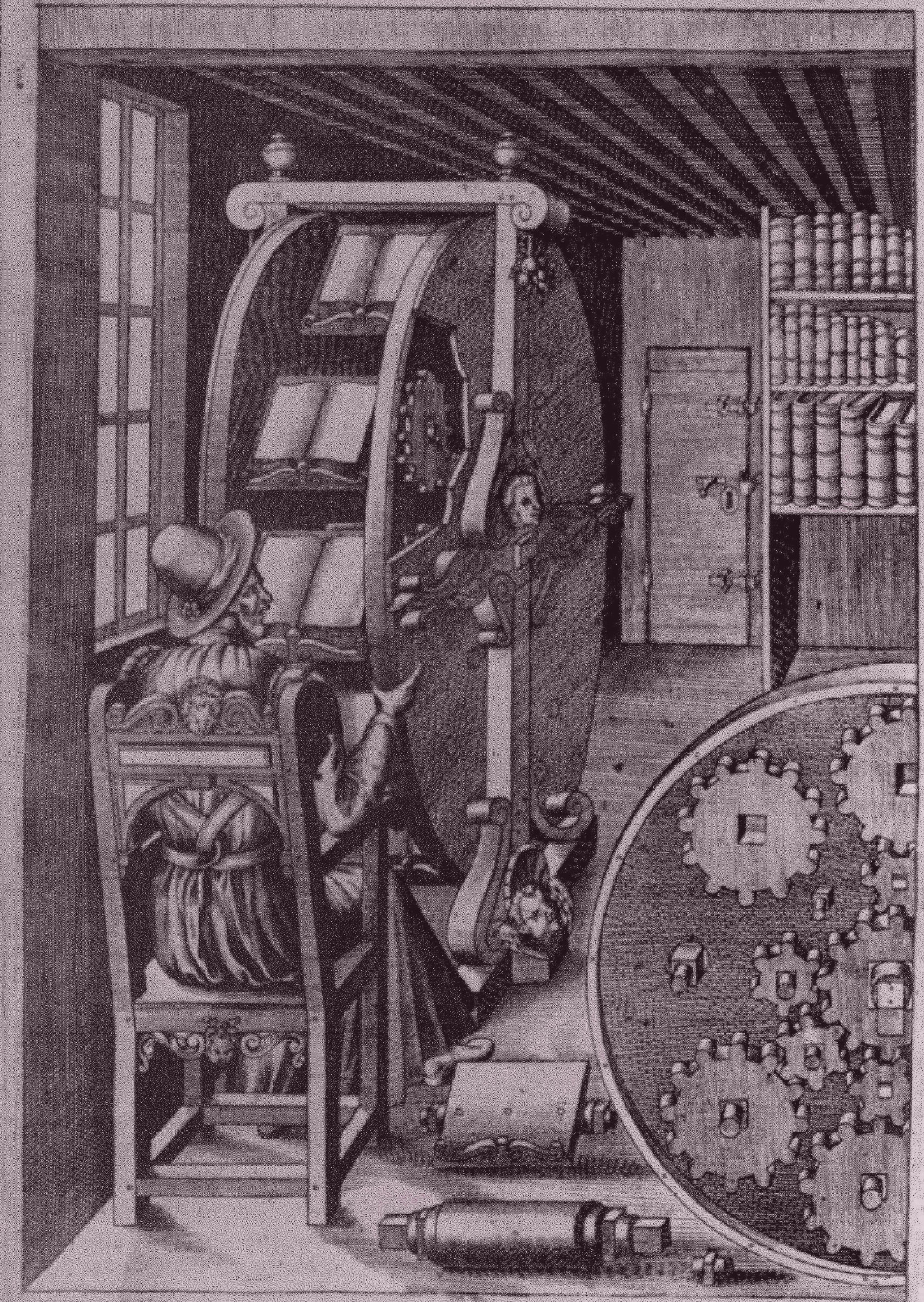
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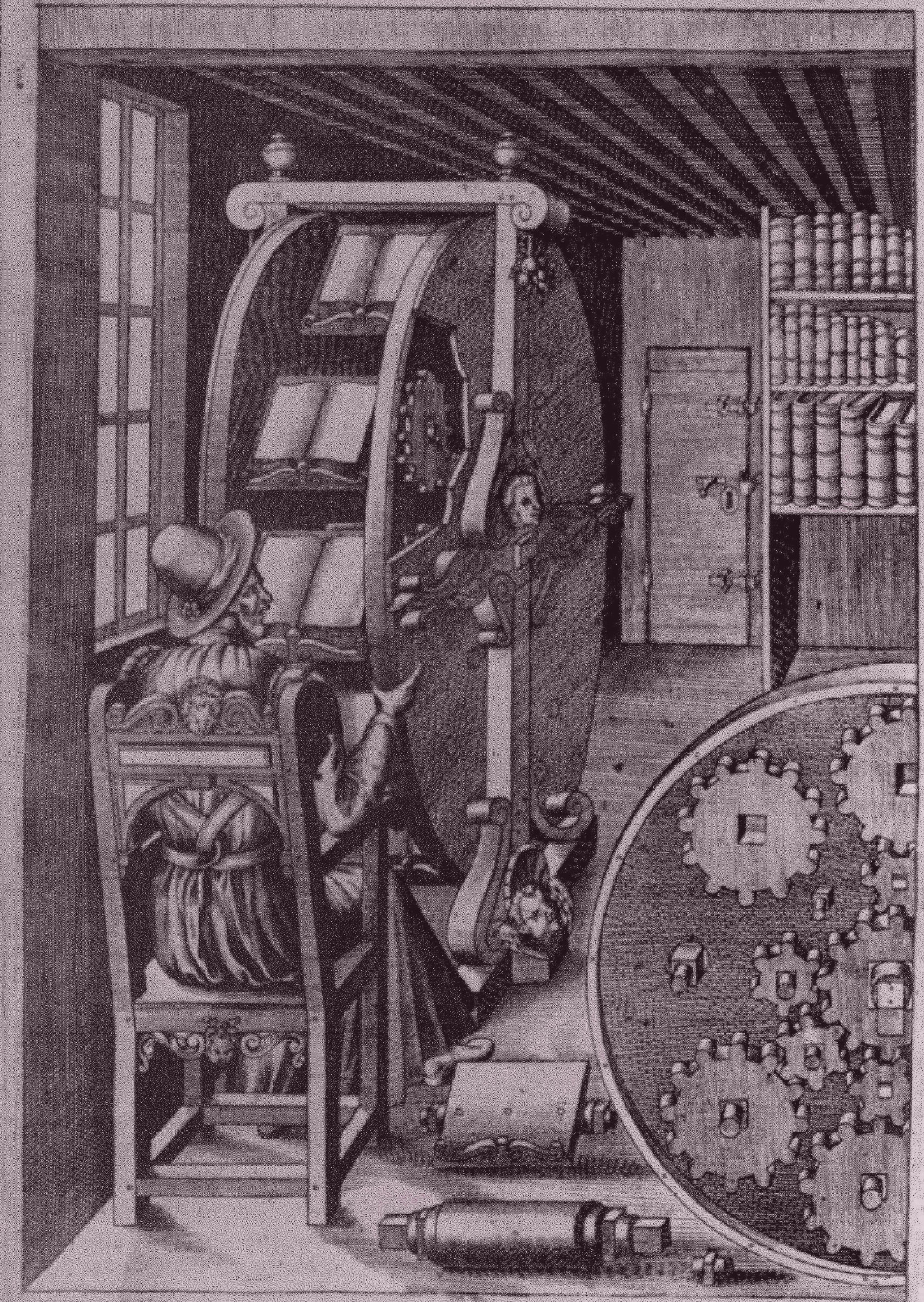
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- Machines = physical embodiment of bosses' social power



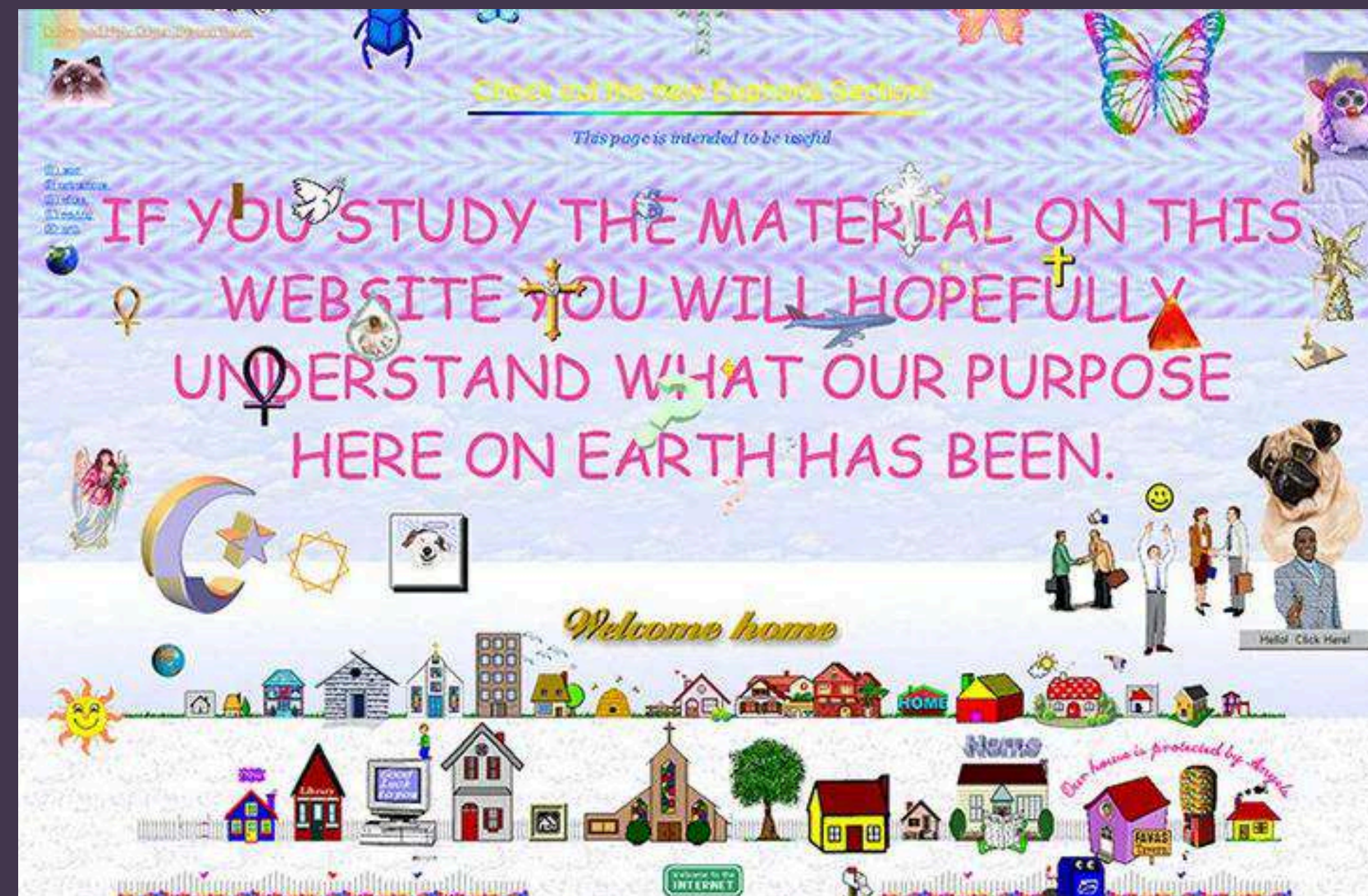
Arc of permacomputing_politics

1. Survivalist ethics

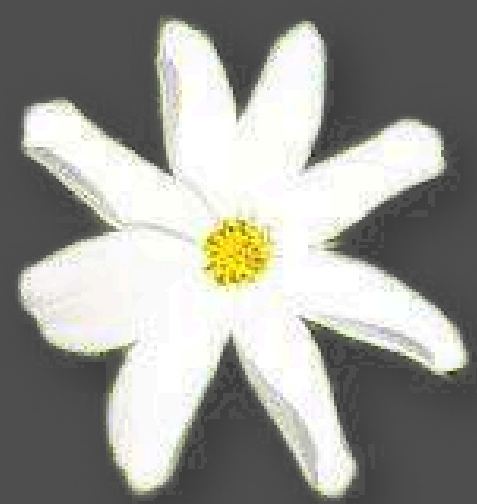
2. Ecofeminist & decolonial

3. Degrowth

4. Collectivity as a backbone



Morbid symptoms persist...



Brewing Collectives

← → ↻ 🔒 brewing.permacomputing.net 67% ☆ ⬇ ⬇ 5 🦊 🌐 ☰

brewing

collectives

☐ inside ☐ morning ☐ day ☒ night

how to start a permacomputing collective

This is a guide brewed from conversations with initiatives in London (UK), Berlin (DE), Prague (CZ), Philadelphia (USA), Rotterdam (NL), Vienna (AT), Lutruwtia (Tas/AU), County Mayo (IE) and a community from Middle America gathering on servers. This text can support you when starting a permacomputing collective. It isn't a strict recipe but more of a loose framework that can be freely modified to suit local tastes and conditions. Many actions are cyclical and can be seen as opportunities to revisit or re-purpose later.

Start where it makes sense for you.

► Wait... what is permacomputing?

► We use fermenting as a model for collective action

brew the base

stories about how groups started

add the starter

early organizing & infrastructure

let it ferment

governance, challenges, and ongoing culture

pour and share

reflections, advice, and spreading practices

brewing.permacomputing.net/add_the_starter.html

...communities keep finding the cracks.